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DATABASE ADMINISTRATOR

JOB DESCRIPTION

Companies in almost every sector, from engineering to marketing, rely on accurate data to make key business decisions. Database administrators store and organize data in databases that recognize patterns in the information. They ensure the databases run efficiently, providing users with data when they need it.

SALARY

Graduate ★★☆☆☆

Experienced administrator ★★★★★

INDUSTRY PROFILE

Worldwide job opportunities • Possibility of working in a variety of sectors, from publishing to finance • Every website at least partly comes from a database

SKILLS GUIDE



Good communication skills to understand and supply accurate data as it is requested.



Efficient time management skills for dealing with constant data-processing requests.



Problem-solving skills to ensure that data is backed up reliably, easy to retrieve, and secure.



A strong interest in, and a good understanding of, software and coding.



Attention to detail to fix—or avoid—computer bugs that can cause problems in a database.

RELATED CAREERS

- ▶ **SOFTWARE ENGINEER** *see pp. 118–119*
- ▶ **SYSTEMS ANALYST** *see pp. 120–121*
- ▶ **NETWORK ENGINEER** *see pp. 124–125*
- ▶ **WEB DEVELOPER** *see pp. 128–129*
- ▶ **FINANCIAL PROGRAMMER** Works with modern programming languages to write software used by financial institutions, such as banks.
- ▶ **INFORMATION SCIENTIST** Manages an organization's information resources, such as databases, online services, books, and paper-based records.
- ▶ **IT CONSULTANT** Advises a business on how to improve its IT infrastructure. They must have a good knowledge of databases, networks, and all different kinds of software.